
Example document

How Markdown Becomes a Typeset PDF

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Contents

1	Overview	2
1.1	Goals	2
2	Failure Handling	2
3	Measurements	3
4	Cross References	4

1 Overview

This document was written by an LLM as an example of what the builder can produce. It exists to exercise diagrams, tables, and cross references in one place, so read it as a sample of the output and not as a source of fact. The pipeline it describes is real and matches the code. Every number in it is invented: nothing in Section 3 was measured, and the timings there are illustrative only.

This note describes the pipeline that turns a Markdown file into a typeset PDF. The stages are sketched in Figure 1 on page 2, the failure handling in Section 2, and the cost of each stage in Section 3.

Every diagram here is written as TikZ source inside the Markdown file. Nothing is imported, and nothing was drawn by hand.

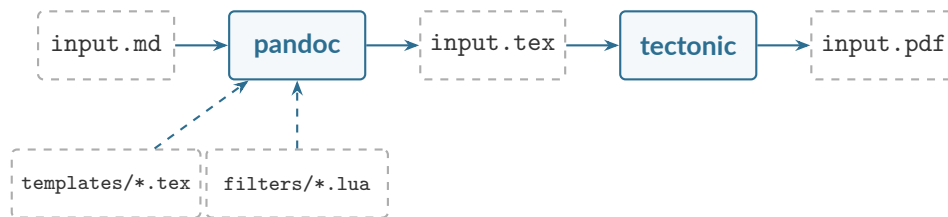


Figure 1: The two external programs, the files that steer pandoc, and the intermediate .tex left on disk beside the source.

1.1 Goals

- Keep the source readable as plain text
- Let one metadata key change the entire look
- Fail with a message that names the offending line

2 Failure Handling

Either external program can reject the document. The decision the builder makes is shown in Figure 2.

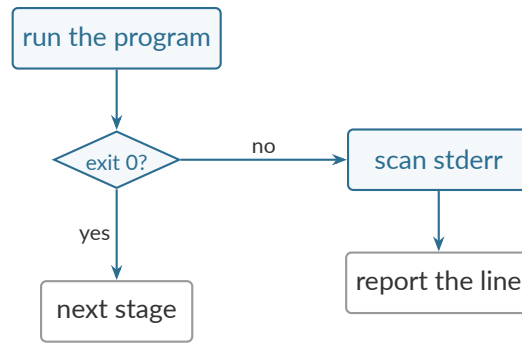


Figure 2: Error handling shared by both stages.

A document that never reaches `tectonic` costs nothing to fail, which is why the cheap check runs first.

3 Measurements

Build time splits unevenly between the two stages. Figure 3 plots a made up wall clock time for each stage, drawn entirely in TikZ without a plotting package.

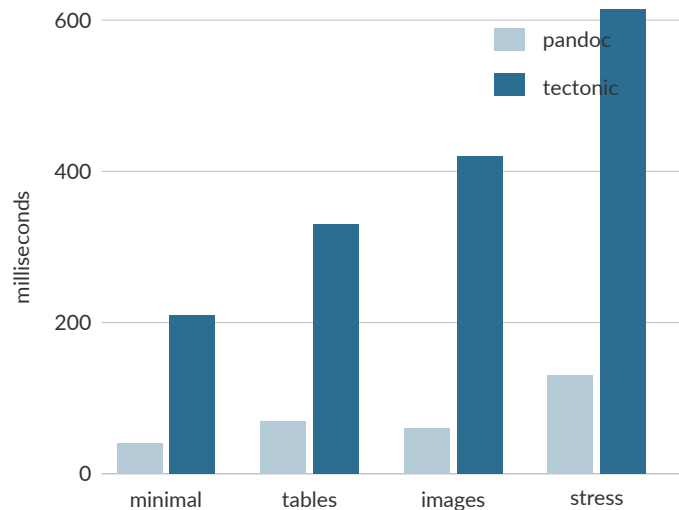


Figure 3: Invented figures, shown to demonstrate a chart drawn in TikZ rather than to report a measurement.

The same invented numbers, for anyone who would rather read them:

Table 1:

Document	pandoc (ms)	tectonic (ms)	Total (ms)
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Table 1: (Continued)

minimal	40	210	250
tables	70	330	400
images	60	420	480
stress	130	615	745

Raster images pass through the same figure machinery as the diagrams above, so they can be referenced the same way. Figure 4 is a PNG.



Figure 4: A raster image, numbered alongside the drawn ones.

4 Cross References

Both reference styles work in the same document.

Raw LaTeX, which numbers the target: Section 1 introduces the pipeline, Figure 2 shows the error path, and Figure 3 appears on page 3.

GFM anchors, which link by name: [the overview](#), [failure handling](#), and [the goals](#).